

The Benefits of Docker Toolbox, Docker Desktop and WSL 2

Docker is a Platform as a Service (PaaS) product, using which developers can build, ship and run their applications inside Docker containers. Now used everywhere, it is the new way of application deployment. The Docker Toolbox, Docker Desktop and the Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL) are all designed to expand its reach and make life easier for developers.



of the new Docker Desktop, then Docker Toolbox can help you. Docker Toolbox is not managed by Docker but is available for use on GitHub. It provides you with a Docker Quickstart Terminal, Kitematic, and Oracle VirtualBox. Docker Quickstart Terminal is a preconfigured Docker CLI, while Kitematic provides a GUI for Docker. Docker engine commands like *docker-machine* and *docker-compose* are also included.

The questions that arise are: how is Docker Toolbox enabling us to use Docker on Windows? What is the technology underlying it? As stated earlier, Docker Toolbox includes Oracle VirtualBox as well. What could be the purpose of a virtual machine in using Docker on Windows? Let's answer these questions.

Linux-specific kernel features namespace and Cgroup, which are used by the Docker Engine Daemon. Thus, running Docker inherently on Windows is not possible. So, the Windows system hosts the Docker Engine on a compact Linux virtual machine, which is created by Docker Toolbox using the Docker machine command for creating and attaching this machine. Also, this machine is very small and may not run many commands. Let us look at the installation process and how the toolbox can be used.

Docker has revolutionised the DevOps pipeline. A Docker image, as most of us know, is a static representation of the application, as well as its configuration and dependencies. These images are stored in a remote public registry, called Docker Hub. Thus, to run an application stored as an image, we must pull the image and run it in a container. For those who do not have any background knowledge about Docker, a container is a live instantiation of an image. As Docker has become

a huge success, one might want to learn about this technology without having a separate Linux installation. This is where Docker for Windows comes in. It not only allows you to run Docker service on Windows but also provides a nice GUI for those who are not very comfortable with the command line interface (CLI). Let us see what Docker for Windows can offer to its users.

Docker Toolbox

If your Windows is older than 16299 and does not satisfy the requirements

